Oregon Coast Weekend Trip Planning

Conversation with Claude · 13-Oct-2026 · N211WP (DA40 XLS), KSBA → Newport, OR (KONP)

13-Oct-2026 09:27 PDT

I'm thinking about a weekend trip over the next, sometime over the next few weeks to the Pacific coast of Oregon, period. What do things look like in terms of airports and possible weather?

The near-term picture is mixed. This coming weekend has a usable gap, but the pattern turns wet from Sunday night. The later weekends are past any real forecast range.

[ForeFlight weather widgets omitted]

Airports (from ForeFlight airport data)

Airport	Longest runway	100LL	Notes (from ForeFlight pilot reports)
KAST Astoria	5,794 × 100	$6.49	Crew car. Medevac helicopter parks close to the self-serve pump.
KTMK Tillamook	5,001 × 75	$7.00	Two loaner cars. Avoid north-side transient tie-downs, where recessed holes can trap a tire.
KONP Newport	5,398 × 100	$7.99	Crew car. Park away from the medevac hangar. FBO may close early.
6S2 Florence	3,000 × 60	$7.20	Volunteer-run, so call ahead for the courtesy car. Turbulent in north winds.
KOTH North Bend	5,980 × 150	$8.00	Repeated reports of high landing/use fees.
S05 Bandon	3,601 × 60	$6.80	Shifting winds, with windsocks that sometimes disagree. Shuttle to Bandon Dunes.

Distance (my great-circle estimate, assuming N211WP from KSBA): about 575 nm to KOTH and about 640 nm to KONP. That's one fuel stop in the DA40 either way.

This weekend, 16–18 Oct

These are ForeFlight's 10-day model outlooks for KONP and KOTH plus the NWS Portland discussion. Treat them as a trend, not a TAF.

- **Thursday 15-Oct:** The best day of the week. The ridge peaks with sun and low 70s at Newport and upper 70s at North Bend. NWS also expects offshore east flow over the Cascades Wednesday night through Friday morning. The strongest winds are Thursday, with 20–40% odds of ridgetop gusts over 30 mph along the crest. Expect bumps on any route that crosses terrain.

- **Friday 16-Oct:** VFR into early afternoon. From about 3 PM PDT, the hourly model brings in stratus at both KONP and KOTH, with ceilings around 300–400 ft and visibility 2–3 sm. It lasts overnight. So you'd want to arrive Thursday or by early Friday afternoon.
- **Saturday 17-Oct:** Low IFR in the morning, lifting to about 1,100 ft by late morning. The afternoon goes partly cloudy with NNW winds of 10G18 at Newport and 15G25 at North Bend.
- **Sunday 18-Oct:** The daytime looks workable, mostly cloudy with high ceilings. Rain moves in Sunday evening.
- **Monday 19-Oct and Tuesday 20-Oct:** Showers both days, at 75% and 60% probability. NWS puts the chance of at least 0.25 in. of rain on the coast from Saturday to Monday at 30–45%. By Monday they expect the trough to bring more widespread rain.

My read: fly up Thursday, enjoy Saturday afternoon, and come back early Sunday ahead of the trough. That works if you want this weekend. With freezing levels near 12,000 ft today and a Gulf of Alaska trough arriving, I'd expect icing to matter for any IFR return early next week in a non-FIKI airplane. That's inferred from the winds-aloft temperatures and the synoptic setup, not taken from an icing product.

24-Oct and later

These dates are beyond the forecast horizon, so the only honest input is climatology. Late October is when the Oregon coast's wet season usually gets going. Your Weather History and Probability app would give you better odds for KONP or KAST than I can from memory.

Want me to run PlaneWX departure windows for KSBA→KONP on Thursday and Friday, with a Sunday return?

13-Oct-2026 09:29 PDT

Sure.

Friday morning comes out best, not Thursday. Thursday is held down by low ceilings at Newport, which changes what I told you earlier. Sunday's return scores are soft because the forecast is so far out.

All runs were VFR at 7,000 in N211WP (PlaneWX defaulted to that aircraft), with your 1,000 ft / 3 SM / 25 kt minimums. The ETEs are cruise-only at 137 KTAS with winds, about 4.5–4.8 hours. They include no fuel stop, climb, descent or taxi.

Outbound KSBA → KONP

Depart	WX Score	Confidence	What drives it
Thu 15-Oct 07:00 (arr. 11:40)	75, Favorable	83, Good	−25: KONP ceiling 500–900 ft (GFS MOS 06Z, for 1800Z)

Thu 15-Oct 10:00 (arr. 14:32)	75, Favorable	80, Good	−25: KONP ceiling 200–400 ft (GFS MOS 06Z, for 0000Z). Arrival MVFR.
Thu 15-Oct 12:00 (arr. 16:27)	75, Favorable	80, Good	Same 200–400 ft ceiling. Arrival MVFR.
Fri 16-Oct 07:00 (arr. 11:36)	**95, Favorable**	80, Good	−5: KSBA visibility missing. KONP ceiling clear below 12,000 (NBM).
Fri 16-Oct 09:00 (arr. 13:36)	**95, Favorable**	80, Good	Same as 07:00.
Fri 16-Oct 11:00 (arr. 15:32)	95, Favorable	67, Moderate	−5: 56% precipitation probability at KONP. Ceiling and visibility not available.

Things to know before trusting these:

- **Thursday's score looks too generous.** All three Thursday runs flag the KONP ceiling as below your 1,000 ft hard minimum, yet they still score 75, Favorable, and `hard_limit_hits` is empty. I'd treat Thursday as a ceiling problem regardless of the band.
- **The sources disagree on Thursday.** PlaneWX grades a 200–900 ft ceiling from the GFS MOS 06Z run. The ForeFlight MOS I pulled earlier (issued 16:20Z) shows FEW/SCT at 300–700 ft Thursday afternoon, which is not a ceiling. ForeFlight's daily outlook also shows sunny. The likely reasons are a different MOS run or a different cloud-cover reading. No TAF covers Thursday yet, and PlaneWX suggests re-briefing in about 22 hours, when one should.
- **Friday 07:00 and 09:00 have an internal inconsistency.** The constraint check says visibility is below 3 SM. The comparison summary says KSBA and KONP visibility are both not available. Check the full briefing on those two.
- **Friday afternoon still matters.** ForeFlight's hourly had KONP dropping to about 300 ft around 3 PM Friday, so a 09:00 departure arriving around 13:36 leaves some margin. The 11:00 departure doesn't leave much.

Surface winds were light on every run where they were available, for example Thursday 07:00: KSBA runway 07 4 kt crosswind, KONP runway 16 7 kt, against your 25 kt limit. No icing was flagged on the climb or en route for any run.

Return KONP → KSBA, Sunday 18-Oct

Depart	WX Score	Confidence	What drives it
08:00	85, Favorable	58, Moderate	−15: extended forecast (118 h) limits confidence
11:00	80, Favorable	55, Moderate	−15: 71% precipitation probability at departure. −5: marginal ceilings, and the constraint check flags the ceiling below 1,000 ft.

13:00	100, Favorable	55, Moderate	No deductions, but ceiling, visibility and crosswind at both ends are **not available**. That's missing data, not good weather.

Treat Sunday as a placeholder. It's about 120 hours out, and the scores fit the trough timing we saw earlier: the earlier you leave, the better. Re-run it Friday or Saturday.

Briefing links

- Fri 07:00 out: [redacted]
- Fri 09:00 out: [redacted]
- Fri 11:00 out: [redacted]
- Thu 07:00 out: [redacted]
- Thu 10:00 out: [redacted]
- Thu 12:00 out: [redacted]
- Sun 08:00 back: [redacted]
- Sun 11:00 back: [redacted]
- Sun 13:00 back: [redacted]

This used 9 of your 60 PlaneWX scoring runs for today. If you'd like, I can save the Friday 09:00 / Sunday 08:00 pair as a PlaneWX trip, or draft the flight in ForeFlight with a fuel stop. KMHS or KRDD would be the natural midpoints.

13-Oct-2026 09:32 PDT

Yes, pls.

Both are set up.

PlaneWX now has two saved trips, each with a fresh briefing queued:

- KSBA→KONP, Fri 16-Oct 09:00: [redacted]
- KONP→KSBA, Sun 18-Oct 08:00: [redacted]

They carry over the candidates as scored: nonstop at 7,000 ft. They don't know about the KRDD stop.

ForeFlight has four flights in N211WP (primary) with the WAM 1WP W&B profile, all VFR direct:

Flight	Departs	Altitude
1/4 KSBA–KRDD	Fri 16-Oct 09:00	8,500
2/4 KRDD–KONP	Fri 16-Oct 12:45	8,500

3/4 KONP–KRDD	Sun 18-Oct 08:00	9,500
4/4 KRDD–KSBA	Sun 18-Oct 10:45	7,500

I picked the altitudes for VFR hemispheric rules: westbound northbound, eastbound southbound. I went to 9,500 for the KONP–KRDD leg to clear the Klamath terrain. That's my reasoning, so change them if you like a different routing. I estimated the leg-2 and leg-4 departure times at about 2:50 en route plus a 45-minute turn. No performance profile was set, so ForeFlight will use the aircraft default.

Two things to look at:

- **Friday timing is tight.** With the fuel stop, you'd reach KONP around 14:45–15:00. ForeFlight's hourly model had stratus at roughly 300 ft moving in about 15:00. Moving leg 1 to 07:00 gets you there around 13:00. I can shift both Friday legs if you want.
- **KRDD runway condition.** ForeFlight's data rates both runways (13-31 and 17-35) as "P" surface quality. Worth checking NOTAMs before you commit to it. KMHS is the backup if it's rough.

13-Oct-2026 09:35 PDT

For the overnights in KONP, pls find 3 possible AirBnBs, a couple eateries for lunch/dinner, and maybe some sights to see or things to do.

[Map of restaurants and sights omitted]

Airbnb options

I couldn't check availability or prices for 16–18 Oct from here. These are three specific Nye Beach listings that are oceanfront and walkable to the restaurants.

1. [redacted] An entire 2-bedroom, 1-bath condo sleeping 6, hosted by a Superhost with 8 years hosting. It has a private deck, a shared lawn and an ocean lookout over Nye Beach. It's the roomiest of the three.
2. [redacted] A third-floor studio for 2, rated 4.53 across 233 reviews and managed by Avari. It has a full kitchen, a covered deck and access to a shared pool, a few minutes' walk from Nye Beach cafes and shops.
3. [redacted] A top-floor corner unit right on Nye Beach, managed by Vacasa, rated 4.53 across 30 reviews. It has smartlock self check-in, about a mile from the Bayfront and two miles from the aquarium. Check-in is 4:00 p.m. and check-out is 10:00 a.m. Self check-in is handy if Friday runs late.

Tineo has Airbnb search tools that could check real availability for your dates. *[Connector card omitted]*

Eating (hours from Google)

- **Friday dinner: Local Ocean Seafoods** on the Bayfront is the standout and is open until 9 PM Friday and Saturday. **Sharks** is a small family-run steamer bar out on North Coast Highway, known for cioppino. It's dinner only from 4:30 PM, closed Sunday and Monday, so Friday or Saturday only.
- **Lunch: Clearwater** has window tables over the sea lion docks. **Sal De Mar** is counter-service fish tacos and fish & chips, also open for dinner until 7 PM.
- **Sunday before the 08:00 departure: Shay's Marina View Cafe** opens at 7:00, which is tight but doable.

Things to do, fit to the forecast

- **Saturday morning, when the stratus is likely low:** the **Oregon Coast Aquarium**, 10 AM–5 PM, works fine in fog. The **Historic Bayfront** walk with the sea lions is also good in any weather.
- **Saturday afternoon, once it clears: Yaquina Head**, where the lighthouse closes at 4:30. It's the tallest light in Oregon, with tide pools below. **Devils Punchbowl** at Otter Rock is about 15 minutes north and is best at low tide. **Yaquina Bay Lighthouse** is open 12–4 on Saturday.

Getting around: KONP is about 4 miles south of town across the Yaquina Bay Bridge. Call the Newport FBO at (541) 867-7422 to ask whether the crew car can go overnight. If it can't, line up a rental.